

Cookies policy

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This Cookies policy is an integral part of the "Privacy Policy" and shall be read and interpreted in conjunction with it.

QFREEMART operates a digital marketplace platform that connects customers with independent vendors and service providers. Vendors using the platform may operate their own websites or services and may use their own cookies or similar technologies in accordance with their respective privacy policies.

1 About cookies and similar technologies

A cookie, being a small text file, is automatically transmitted to your device and subsequently stored by your web browser. Within this cookie resides a distinctive identifier (comprising a sequence of random characters) which distinguishes your browser from others. Cookies frequently serve the purpose of establishing a connection between your browser and databases that retain information regarding your usage patterns, inferred interests, and additional data like your IP address. These cookies fulfill various functions, ranging from facilitating the functionality of the website by recognizing you as the same user while navigating between pages, to analyzing popular content and personalized content based on browsing behavior and interests.

Cookies can be stored by the website you visit (known as "first-party cookies"), or by technology providers such as analytics companies, advertising networks, or social media platforms (known as "third-party cookies"). Third-party cookies may be employed to correlate your browsing behavior across multiple websites. Cookies are either stored for the duration of your visit (referred to as "session cookies"), or they persist on your device for a predetermined period (typically several months or longer) to remember you across multiple browsing sessions (referred to as "persistent cookies"). Alternative forms of storage, such as local or "HTML" storage

2. What types of cookies and similar technologies do we use?

We use the following types of cookies:

Session cookies: are stored for the duration of a browser session; when you close the browser, the cookie is deleted.

Persistent cookies: are stored for a preset amount of time (often between 90 days and two years, depending on the application) and are typically not deleted when a browser session is closed.

First-party cookies: These cookies are set by our website or mobile application.

Third-party cookies: These cookies are set by a third-party website or service, such as an advertising network.

Your choices may affect whether we use session or persistent cookies for a particular application. For example, if you select "Remember Me," your two-step verification status is stored on a persistent cookie for 30 days to remember the device that you signed in from.

3. What other similar technologies do we use?

Websites and email communications may employ embedded code, also known as pixels, to monitor your interactions with them. This code recognizes your browser through the unique identifier stored in their cookie or your device's "AdID." Such tracking technologies are frequently employed to transmit data about your browsing activities to third parties, such as social media companies or advertisers, in order to measure engagement with their content or to personalize advertisements or marketing materials.

3.1 Local storage

Local storage enables a website or application to store information locally on your device(s). Local storage may be used to improve the QFREEMART experience, for example, by enabling features, remembering your preferences and speeding up site functionality.

3.2 Pixels

A pixel is a tiny image that may be embedded within web pages and emails, requiring a call (which provides device and visit information) to our servers in order for the pixel to be rendered in those web pages and emails. We use pixels to learn more about your interactions with email content or web content, such as whether you interacted with ads or posts. Pixels can also enable us and third parties to place cookies on your browser.

3.3 Beacons

For example, we may place web beacons in marketing emails that notify us when you click on a link in the email that directs you to one of our websites. Such tracking technologies are used to operate and improve our websites and email communications and track the clicking of links or opening of emails.

3.4 Log files

We collect non-personal information through our Internet log files, which record data such as browser types, domain names, and other anonymous statistical data involving the use of the QFREEMART services. This information may be used to analyze trends, to administer the QFREEMART services, to monitor the use of the QFREEMART services, and to gather general demographic information. In certain circumstances, aggregated log data may be analyzed together with other operational data to improve services, investigate security incidents, or enhance user experience. Where personal data is involved, such processing will be conducted in accordance with the Privacy Policy and applicable data protection laws.

4. What are Mobile Application Cookies?

Mobile applications may use technologies similar to cookies such as local storage, device identifiers, and application storage mechanisms to retain user preferences and support application functionality. Unlike traditional browser cookies, these technologies may rely on platform-specific storage systems provided by the mobile operating system. These technologies may serve purposes similar to cookies, such as retaining user preferences, monitoring application activity, and customizing the user experience. It is worth noting that mobile applications might employ alternative technologies like local storage or key-value pairs to store data in lieu of cookies. Moreover, certain mobile platforms may impose limitations on the usage of cookies, particularly with regards to safeguarding user privacy."

4.1 How are Mobile Application Cookies Utilised?

Mobile application cookies find application in various capacities, encompassing:
Retaining user preferences, encompassing language selection and font size
Monitoring user activities spanning across diverse applications and websites
Tailoring the user experience to individual preferences
Delivering targeted advertisements"

4.2 How do Mobile Application Cookies Differ from Web Browser Cookies?

Mobile Web cookies:

Cookies are also present on the mobile web, just like they are on desktop devices. Users who browse the Internet using mobile web browsers have cookies placed on their browsers. Each mobile browser, similar to desktop browsers, possesses distinct cookie settings and manages first-party and third-party cookies in varying ways. In essence, cookies function entirely on the mobile web. The primary constraint of cookies on mobile browsers is that they reset when the browser is closed or when the phone is powered off or restarted.

Mobile application cookies exhibit dissimilarities compared to web browser cookies in several aspects. Firstly, mobile application cookies are stored on the user's device, whereas web browser cookies are stored on the user's computer. Secondly, mobile application cookies are capable of tracking user behavior across different apps and websites, while web browser cookies can solely track user behavior on a single website. Lastly, certain mobile platforms may impose limitations on the utilization of cookies, especially concerning user privacy concerns.

We employ restricted usage of cookies within Mobile Apps. In certain cases, mobile platforms may provide device identifiers such as an advertising identifier (a randomly generated and resettable identifier provided by the operating system). These identifiers may be used, subject to user permissions and platform policies, for analytics, service improvement, or advertising measurement purposes. In some cases, this information may be analyzed together with other operational data such as approximate geographic or network location to improve service performance and user experience. This data is utilized in a manner akin to cookies, such as for analyzing and enhancing services, as well as delivering marketing and advertising content to you (if the App is supported by advertising).

In summary, while cookies might be utilized in mobile applications, the actual implementation relies on the particular app and the platform it is constructed upon.

More information

All about cookies (<http://www.allaboutcookies.org/>)

5. How cookies are used on our services?

Cookies are employed for the designated purposes outlined below. The precise cookies utilized by a particular service are enumerated and explicated within the cookie management platform specific to that service. This information is presented to you upon your initial visit to the website, during periodic updates of the cookies utilized, and/or when we periodically request you to review your preferences. Accessing the preference center can be done by clicking on "Cookie Settings," typically located in the footer of the service.

Necessary: These cookies are of vital importance as they are technically indispensable for ensuring the efficient functioning of the service. Their purpose includes facilitating your navigation within the service, remembering your cookie preferences, maintaining the security of our service, and managing system administration tasks such as preventing fraudulent or disruptive activities. Without these cookies, the service may not be able to operate as intended, making them non-optional in nature.

Functional: These cookies serve to enhance your experience or provide requested features by supporting specific functionalities. They are designed to improve the overall user experience by adding valuable capabilities or fulfilling specific user requests.

Statistics/Performance: These cookies are employed to facilitate the analysis and enhancement of the service's performance. They play a crucial role in providing valuable insights such as the total number of users, the most popular sections of our sites, the preferred web browsers (enabling us to optimize compatibility), the geographical location of our users, as well as their demographics and interests. This information enables us to gain a better understanding of our user base, ensure effective targeting of our intended audience, and enhance and customize our services accordingly. Furthermore, cookies may be utilized to measure the effectiveness of our marketing campaigns, both online and through email communications.

Marketing: These cookies enable us to display marketing messages or advertisements on our Services as well as other online platforms. They also facilitate our assessment of the effectiveness of our marketing efforts, including whether you have viewed or interacted with any of our advertisements. In order to promote our services to you, we may employ marketing technologies that allow for personalized messaging based on your usage of the service and inferred interests. Additionally, these cookies support social media functionalities, such as enabling you to share our content via your social media accounts and embedding content from social media platforms, such as videos. It's important to note that the companies providing these services may utilize cookies to deliver these features or to track your usage of their respective services.

6. Third party cookies

We collaborate with several specialized companies that assist us in the efficient operation of our services and the provision of marketing functionalities, as elucidated in the preceding section. These technology providers utilize and manage cookies on our services, which may also be utilized for their own purposes, including the tracking of your browsing behavior across multiple websites. We carry out thorough assessments that these companies maintain the security of your data and handle it in a fair and responsible manner.

7. Your choices

We believe that by providing these choices, we empower you to tailor your cookie settings according to your privacy preferences. Our aim is to ensure a transparent and user-centric experience within our mobile app. We aim to ensure that you can make informed decisions regarding your privacy preferences. Therefore, we provide you with the following choices regarding cookies:

Consent for Cookie Usage:

We prioritize your consent. Prior to deploying any cookies within our app, we will explicitly ask for your consent. We will clearly explain the specific behaviors that the cookies will track. You will have the option to either consent or reject the use of cookies.

Mobile App Consent Management Tools:

To ensure compliance with international privacy laws and facilitate the collection of user consent, we utilize mobile app consent management tools. These tools assist us in obtaining and managing your consent for cookie usage.

Managing or Disabling Cookies in Mobile Device Settings

The steps for disabling cookies in mobile device settings will vary depending on the device and operating system. However, in general, you can find the settings by going to the Settings app, then selecting Privacy or Security. From there, you should be able to find an option to disable cookies.

Deleting Existing Cookies:

If you desire, you can choose to delete any existing cookies stored on your mobile device. This option enables you to clear previously stored cookie data.

Uninstalling Apps That Use Cookies

If you are concerned about the privacy implications of mobile application cookies, you can uninstall any apps that you do not trust. To uninstall an app, open the App Store or Google Play app, then find the app that you want to uninstall. Tap the app's icon, then tap Uninstall.

Using Browsers That Do Not Support Cookies

There are a few mobile browsers that do not support cookies. These browsers include Firefox Focus and DuckDuckGo Privacy Browser. If you are concerned about the privacy implications of mobile application cookies, you can use one of these browsers instead of your default mobile browser.

It is important to note that disabling cookies may impact your ability to use some mobile applications. For example, you may not be able to log in to some apps or you may not be able to receive push notifications. Additionally, some apps may not function properly if cookies are disabled.

Allowing, Blocking, and Setting Preferences:

You have the flexibility to allow or block all cookies based on your preferences. Additionally, you can set specific preferences for certain websites, allowing you to have control over the types of cookies you wish to accept.

Google Chrome browser (<https://support.google.com/chrome/answer/95647?hl=en>)

Microsoft Internet Explorer browser (<https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/help/17442/windows-internet-explorer-delete-manage-cookies>)

Mozilla Firefox browser (<http://support.mozilla.org/en-US/kb/cookies-information-websites-store-on-your-computer?redirectlocale=en-US&redirectslug=Cookies>)

Apple Safari browser (<https://support.apple.com/en-ae/HT201265>)

If you are concerned about the privacy implications of mobile application cookies, you should weigh the benefits and drawbacks of disabling cookies before making a decision.

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